THW abolish the death penalty

GOVERNMENT

Definition:

- "the death penalty" - when a criminal is sentenced to death by a jury
- "abolish" - completely get rid of the death sentence (in principle + practice)

Points:

- Right to live
    - All humans have the right to life, regardless of their actions
    - All humans have potential value to be good/developmental individualism
    - Limited state: if right to life is intrinsic, then the state taking it away is a massive overstep of its powers
- Expensive
    - In the US it costs more to do the death penalty for the tax payer than life imprisonment would.
    - Scope: stakeholders are everybody who pays tax
    - Opportunity cost: money spent on the death penalty could be redirected to other more useful things which would lead to greater public benefit
        - e.g. education, public infrastructure, public investment
- People could be wrongly convicted/mistakes could be made
    - Leading to innocent lives being lost

OPPOSITION

Rebuttal

- right to life – if a person takes somebody else's life away, why should they have the right to life themselves?

Points

- Safety - death penalty leads to abolishment of crime
    - therefore effective at making society safe again
    - therefore money spent on this is useful + important
- Crime which has been sentenced to the death penalty is severe + done with intent
    - Therefore in order to uphold justice + fairness in the court of law, must be sentenced to death
    - Death penalty is necessary for severe crimes in order for victims to feel justly retributed.
- Death penalty is the most effective deterrent
    - If humans feel that they have a right to life, then the threat being killed by the state (and therefore being rid of your right to life) is going to be the most effective deterrent